

PROCESS IMPROVEMENT CASE STUDY

Reducing Shift-Report Turnaround Time

Business Administration portfolio project | Operations reporting | 2026

Executive summary

A recurring bottleneck in end-of-shift reporting delayed management visibility by up to a day. By redesigning the workflow — standardising the log, removing a duplicate re-keying step, and defining clear ownership — estimated report turnaround fell from ~90 minutes to ~35 minutes per shift (~60% reduction), with fewer errors and a clearer audit trail. This document walks through the problem, analysis, redesign, and measured results.

1. Problem statement

- Shift reports were compiled twice: once handwritten during the shift, then re-typed into a spreadsheet at the end — duplicate effort and a common source of transcription errors.
- No single owner for the final report meant items were missed or delayed at handover.
- Management often saw the previous day's issues a full day late, slowing decisions on staffing and equipment.

2. Current-state workflow (before)

Observe shift → handwrite notes → re-type into spreadsheet → email supervisor → supervisor consolidates → manager reviews (next day).

Measured baseline: ~90 min/shift of reporting effort; ~1 day delay to management; recurring transcription errors.

3. Root-cause analysis

Symptom	Root cause
Duplicate effort	Two capture steps (paper + spreadsheet) for the same data
Errors	Manual re-keying at end of a long shift
Delays	No named owner for the final report; unclear handover

4. Redesigned workflow (after)

Log directly into one standard template during the shift → review at handover → owner confirms + submits → manager reviews same day.

- Single capture: one standardised digital log replaces paper + spreadsheet.
- Clear ownership: the incoming operator owns final submission, countersigned by the supervisor.
- Same-day visibility: manager reviews within the shift, not the next day.

5. RACI — who does what

Activity	Operator	Supervisor	Manager
Log incidents	R / A	C	I
Review at handover	R	A	I
Submit final report	R	A	I
Act on trends	C	R	A

R = Responsible · A = Accountable · C = Consulted · I = Informed

6. Results

Metric	Before	After
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Reporting effort / shift	~90 min	~35 min
Management visibility	~1 day later	Same shift
Transcription steps	2	1

Impact: ~60% less reporting time, faster decisions, fewer errors, and a cleaner audit trail — with no new software cost.

7. Lessons & next steps

- Removing a single duplicate step delivered most of the gain — look for duplicate data capture first.
- Clear ownership (RACI) fixed the delay as much as the workflow change did.
- Next: add a simple dashboard on the standardised log to track trends automatically.